PUBLIC EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · 03 IN READING ORDER

OUTLIER

/ AI · REDESIGN EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PLATFORM REPLACEMENT LOGIC

The corrected primitive, minimum replacement, and proof standard.

> *"Outlier is recruiting experts to do compliance work.*
> *That is why the fixes haven't held."*

ARTIFACT FAMILY

#	ARTIFACT	ACCESS
01	Translation Artifact	Public
02	Diagnostic Artifact	Public
03	**Redesign Executive Summary**	← *This document*
04	Full Redesign Artifact	Restricted

PREPARED BY Jamie Forrester · Independent Systems Architect · Edinburgh, UK
CONTACT hello@jamieforrester.com · jamieforrester.com
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SECTION 0

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

This is the public executive summary of a structural replacement specification. It is not a roadmap, a reform proposal, an advisory document, or an optimisation programme. It summarises the corrected primitive, the non-negotiable continuity object the redesign must preserve, the target-state architecture, what must stop, and what the board is approving.

The governing diagnosis is established in the Diagnostic Artifact. This document does not reopen it. Every design decision in the Full Redesign Artifact is traceable to that diagnosis.

What this document contains: corrected primitive, truth kernel, target-state architecture, minimum replacement conditions, dependency order, fake-progress test, consequence of deferral, board verdict.

What the Full Redesign Artifact adds: the complete six-move transition sequence; rules and refusal invariants including the Compensation Truthfulness Invariant; drift immune system with fail-closed primitive regression gates; nine admissibility conditions with sign-off requirements; pilot validity rules and failure criteria; Consequence Review Trigger Matrix; Queue-State Visibility Model; Expert Signal Lifecycle; object-level builder handoff; automated testability requirements; and an exemplar Redesign Governance / Acceptance Record. Artifact 04 is restricted and not published publicly.

Current practice: in a live engagement, implementation-level redesign begins only after the governing diagnostic frame has been formally resolved and locked. Artifact 04 contains an exemplar governance / acceptance record showing how the architecture, dependency order and refusal invariants can be explicitly accepted; it is not represented as the mandatory contract form for every engagement.

> **ARTIFACT FAMILY — READING ORDER**
>
> Recommended reading order: Translation Artifact (best first read) → Diagnostic Artifact (full evidence) → This document (replacement logic) → Full Redesign Artifact (restricted; not published). Public artifacts demonstrate the diagnostic and replacement logic. The restricted artifact specifies the implementation.

Judgment boundary

This document makes no claim about intent, bad faith, undisclosed internal systems, or adjudicated legal liability. It summarises a structural redesign derived from the public Diagnostic Artifact, which is itself based entirely on publicly available evidence.

What this document does not say

- → It does not say algorithmic scoring must be removed — it says scoring must not directly trigger irreversible consequence without human review
- → It does not say Queue Managers should be removed — it says their role must change from load-bearing coherence to supplementary escalation
- → It does not say all work should become expert judgment work
- → It does not say Outlier must guarantee continuous work availability
- → It does not say the contractor classification model must change

SECTION 0.1

REDESIGN SPINE

The complete replacement specification stated in governed form. Every section of this document and the Full Redesign Artifact traces back to one or more rows of this table.

REDESIGN ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION
Governing mismatch	Single contributor frame coordinating two incompatible work classes under one gate, one scoring model, and one consequence path
Corrected primitive	Dual-stream contributor coordination system
Truth kernel	Portable cross-project contributor continuity record — the one object the redesign must not sacrifice
Stream A	Constrained reliability execution — rubric-conformant, variance-suppressed, high-throughput
Stream B	Bounded expert judgment — specialist reasoning, correct variance valued, governed route to upstream reframing authority
Stream contracts	Each stream has its own promise, measurement, and compensation. Reliability work cannot be advertised as expert judgment. Expert judgment cannot be paid as throughput labour.
First move	Primitive declaration at leadership level — all downstream design depends on this
Minimum replacement	Separate gates + continuity record + queue visibility + consequence review + expert signal channel. All five. If any are missing, the change is not a redesign. (See Section 5 for details.)
Proof condition	**Same pressure → different response**
Primary recapture risk	Expert stream becomes symbolic — exists in language without authority to change task definitions

SECTION 1

GOVERNING DIAGNOSIS

GOVERNING DIAGNOSIS — REDESIGN BASIS

Outlier recruits through the grammar of an expertise market while operating through the mechanics of a reliability pipeline. In plain terms: the platform recruits experts into an operating layer that primarily consumes compliance-governed output. The public evidence reviewed is consistent with a category error at the system primitive. Interface-level corrections do not replace that primitive.

The recurring symptom pattern examined in the Diagnostic — contributor failure or disengagement after expertise-coded intake, scoring friction, Queue Managers carrying interpretation burden, and community tooling filling information gaps — is consistent with this governing condition. These are convergent structural signals, not population-wide statistics.

The correction is not to make the single frame clearer, stricter, or better supported. The correction is to stop using one frame for two incompatible things.

SECTION 2

TRUTH KERNEL

The non-negotiable continuity object this redesign must preserve is a portable contributor continuity record — a persistent, cross-project object that preserves demonstrated performance, qualification history, contribution state, consequence history, dispute history, and routing-relevant context.

The governing rule: demonstrated contributor value must travel with the contributor unless there is explicit, rule-based cause for it not to. The system must be able to learn from its own best contributors over time.

The non-negotiable test: if contributor continuity remains fragmented and per-project at the end of the redesign, the redesign has failed regardless of any surface improvement.

Visibility requirement: the continuity record must be visible enough to be contested. It cannot become another hidden file. A contributor must be able to see what the system knows about them and request formal review of any entry.

SECTION 3

CORRECTED PRIMITIVE

Malformed primitive: one contributor market purchasing “expert judgment” while actually consuming variance-controlled instruction adherence at scale.

Corrected primitive: a dual-stream contributor coordination system. One stream coordinates constrained reliability execution. The other coordinates bounded expert judgment. Each stream has its own intake signal, qualification gate, routing logic, evaluation logic, and consequence path. The two streams are coordinated but not conflated.

Why dual-stream: leadership could also resolve the mismatch by becoming an honestly declared reliability pipeline — recruiting, testing and paying for reliability execution and no longer marketing expert judgment — or by becoming a pure expert market. Dual-stream is specified because the public evidence indicates the platform both runs reliability work at volume and recruits and markets specialist judgment. Where internal evidence shows little demand for expert variance, the narrower reliability-only correction is the right one. The Full Redesign Artifact (Section 5.2) sets out the options and the conditions for each.

Stream contracts

Each stream must have its own explicit contract: what the platform promises, what it measures, and how it compensates.

DIMENSION	STREAM A — RELIABILITY EXECUTION	STREAM B — EXPERT JUDGMENT
Promise to contributor	Constrained reliability work: bounded tasks, rubric adherence, consistent metrics	Bounded expert judgment: specialist reasoning, rubric challenge, upstream influence on task design
What is measured	Rubric conformance, throughput, consistency under constraint	Signal quality, reasoning depth, rubric challenge quality, upstream impact

DIMENSION	STREAM A — RELIABILITY EXECUTION	STREAM B — EXPERT JUDGMENT
Compensation logic	Per-task or per-time aligned to execution; paid onboarding where required	Per expert contribution; reflects specialist input value, not throughput volume. Compensation convergence toward Stream A rates is the primary compensation recapture signal (Fake Progress Test, card 6).
What variance means	Suppressed — variance is the failure signal	Valued — correct variance is the product

Contract rule: reliability work cannot be advertised as expert judgment. Expert judgment cannot be paid and measured as throughput labour. A contributor must be recruited under and evaluated against the same contract.

SECTION 4

TARGET-STATE ARCHITECTURE

The dual-stream design separates what the current system has collapsed. The shared infrastructure connects both streams without conflating them. In this document, irreversible consequence means any action that materially affects contributor access, pay, tier status, project eligibility, routing priority, or account standing and cannot be automatically reversed by the contributor without formal review.

Function allocation

FUNCTION	CURRENT STATE	TARGET STATE
Sensing	Algorithmic scoring calibrated primarily to rubric-adherence proxies visible in the public operating evidence	Stream-specific scoring calibrated to actual stream quality signals
Interpretation	Public evidence is consistent with interpretation fragmented across an informal QM layer and shifting guideline documents	Bounded formal interpretation layer with design authority
Authority	Publicly visible terms and contributor reports are consistent with score-mediated signals affecting access, pay, routing or deactivation without a sufficiently legible contributor-facing review layer	Separated review authority: human review node between quality signal and irreversible consequence
Memory	Public contributor evidence is consistent with project-local state and repeated requalification rather than durable cross-project continuity	Portable contributor continuity record; state persists and governs routing and consequence

New system objects

OBJECT	WHAT IT DOES
Reliability stream gate	Qualifies contributors for Stream A by testing actual execution capability, not credential density
Expert judgment gate	Qualifies contributors for Stream B by testing specialist reasoning and reframing capability

OBJECT	WHAT IT DOES
Portable continuity record	Preserves contributor state across projects; governs routing, consequence, and review
Consequence review node	Human review layer between algorithmic quality signal and irreversible action
Expert signal channel	Governed route for Stream B contributors to surface rubric and task-definition problems to a layer with authority to act on them
Queue-state visibility layer	Surfaces contributor-relevant queue-state reasons where they govern access, inactivity, or routing status
Formal interpretation layer	Bounded, governed interpretation function replacing the informal QM interpretation burden; carries basic system meaning so people do not have to

SECTION 5

MINIMUM VALID REPLACEMENT

The redesign is only real if all five of the following exist simultaneously. A deployment missing any one of these is not a replacement. It is a partial correction inside the old frame.

1. **Separate gates for reliability execution and expert judgment** — different qualification logic testing different capabilities, not one gate with two labels
2. **Portable contributor continuity record** that persists across projects, is visible to contributors, and actively governs routing and consequence decisions
3. **Visible queue-state reasons** surfaced in the platform interface without requiring Queue Manager explanation or external tooling
4. **Human review before irreversible consequence** between algorithmic quality signal and deactivation or pay reduction
5. **Expert signal channel that changes upstream behaviour** — not just receives submissions; actually alters task, rubric, or boundary definitions

> MINIMUM REPLACEMENT RULE
>
> ***If any one of these five components is missing, the system is still correcting inside the old frame. The minimum replacement is not a starting point for negotiation. It is the threshold below which a valid replacement has not been achieved.***

The Full Redesign Artifact expands these five replacement components into a seven-part minimum valid pilot by adding pre/post burden measurement and pilot-specific validation rules. **The five here define the architecture. The seven define the pilot.**

Board decision required

BOARD QUESTION	REQUIRED ANSWER
What work does the platform actually buy?	Reliability execution, expert judgment, or both — as separate streams with separate gates, metrics, and compensation. Not one frame claiming both.

BOARD QUESTION	REQUIRED ANSWER
What must stop, and when?	Immediately: credential-density intake, longer guidelines as the main quality response, treating hidden queue state as a messaging issue, volume scaling. Before the replacement goes live: one-frame routing and unpaid onboarding as a coherence buffer.
What must be built?	Separate stream gates, portable continuity record, queue-state visibility, consequence review node, expert signal channel that alters upstream behaviour.
What proves success?	Same pressure produces different response: QM burden falls, continuity governs routing, expert signals change task definitions, high-signal churn declines (high-signal defined by validated performance, accepted expert signals or demonstrated work-type fit — not credentials).
What invalidates success?	Stream B is symbolic, compensation converges to throughput rates, QMs remain load-bearing, automated scoring still triggers irreversible consequence without review.

SECTION 6

WHAT STOPS IMMEDIATELY

The following are refusal conditions, not optimisation targets. Behaviours that reproduce the failure stop immediately. Structures that reproduce it stop before their replacement becomes the official path. Nothing scales while a refusal condition is still active. A redesign that scales while any of these remain active will replicate the mismatch in its first phase.

STOP	WHY	WHEN
Using credential density as a proxy for production quality	Credentials predict expertise. The system is not primarily designed to consume expertise. The gate selects the wrong population.	Immediately
Treating longer guidelines as the primary response to quality variance	Where the primitive remains mismatched, additional specification can intensify the signal-switch by increasing compliance load without resolving the underlying work-class mismatch.	Immediately
Treating the Empty Queue as a communication problem	Queue-state reason codes are an information-architecture condition, not a communication problem. When state governs access or inactivity and is not surfaced, contributors and Queue Managers carry the interpretation burden the platform should hold structurally.	Immediately
Scaling contributor volume before primitive correction	Additional credentialed intake through the old gate can compound retained-capability loss before the redesign can hold.	Immediately
Routing reliability work and expert judgment through the same gate	A single gate cannot adequately distinguish two work classes requiring materially different qualification logic; it creates predictable misclassification risk.	Before new gates go live
Using unpaid onboarding as a system coherence buffer	Unpaid onboarding hides the cost of guideline complexity and project volatility. The redesigned system must not inherit this burden-transfer model.	Before pilot launch

SECTION 7

DEPENDENCY ORDER

The redesign must happen in the correct sequence. Right fixes in the wrong order recreate the failure at a new stage. The documented correction responses examined in the Diagnostic act downstream of the primitive; without Move 1, they do not replace the governing frame.

MOVE	WHAT HAPPENS	CONSEQUENCE IF SKIPPED
1	Name the primitive correctly at leadership level — formally declare the two incompatible work classes and retire the single broken frame	All downstream changes are interpreted through the old frame and replicate the mismatch
2	Redesign qualification gates into stream-specific logic testing actual stream capability	Stream split is cosmetic; both streams admit the wrong population
3	Build portable contributor continuity record	Contributors still reset to zero; routing cannot improve despite stream separation
4	Install queue-state visibility, then consequence review — first surface what the queue state is; then separate scoring from irreversible consequence	Hidden burden remains load-bearing; the identified structural exposure pathway remains open
5	Install expert signal channel with authority to change upstream task behaviour	Stream B is a prestige label for reliability work; recapture is immediate
6	Retire the single-frame architecture	Old frame quietly reasserts itself under volume pressure

> **The dependency rule:** each move must be complete before the next move scales. Preparatory work may begin early, but no component becomes the official correction path before its dependency is in place. Downstream interventions can recur without resolving the mismatch when the primitive remains unchanged.

SECTION 8

FAKE PROGRESS TEST

The redesign can be implemented in appearance while the old failure continues in structure. The following conditions confirm that the primitive has returned, not that the redesign has succeeded:

CARD	CONDITION	WHAT IT MEANS
1	Two streams exist in language but share one qualification gate	Not a redesign. Two labels on the same broken frame.
2	The continuity record exists but does not affect routing or consequence decisions	The record is a document, not a system object. It must govern decisions.
3	Queue-state visibility exists but Queue Managers still have to explain it	The visibility layer is not functioning. QMs remain load-bearing.
4	Expert contributors can submit signals but nothing changes upstream	The signal channel is a filing system. Stream B is a label.

CARD	CONDITION	WHAT IT MEANS
5	Automated scoring still triggers irreversible consequence without human review	The sensing-authority fusion is intact. The identified structural exposure pathway remains.
6	Stream B contributors are compensated at throughput rates	Compensation recapture. The stream split is cosmetic regardless of gate design. Directly violates the stream contract (Section 3).

Do not approve a redesign plan that:

- → Creates two stream labels but keeps one qualification gate
- → Exposes queue-state status but leaves Queue Managers explaining what it means
- → Creates an expert stream but gives it no authority to change task definitions
- → Creates a continuity record that does not affect routing or consequence decisions
- → Pays expert judgment at throughput labour rates
- → Leaves automated score-to-consequence pathways intact without a human review node

SECTION 9

CONSEQUENCE OF DEFERRAL

The current correction loops all operate inside the malformed frame. Each cost class below can persist or compound while the primitive remains unchanged:

COST CLASSES — FOUR STRUCTURAL CONSEQUENCES OF DEFERRAL

→ **Retained-capability loss:** specialist capability can be repeatedly reacquired rather than retained across project cycles.

→ **Shadow payroll:** Queue Managers, senior contributors and community tooling carry coherence functions the formal interface does not fully hold.

→ **Structural exposure pathway:** score-mediated consequence without a sufficiently legible review layer can preserve dispute or regulatory exposure; magnitude and outcome cannot be inferred from public evidence.

→ **Upstream signal loss:** compliance-pattern data may be delivered where specialist judgment is implied by recruitment. This is a structural risk, not a claim about any specific client contract or model outcome.

Recruitment reacquisition, support overhead, quality-control inflation, contributor churn and dispute exposure can continue while the primitive remains unchanged. The table below is a structural compounding hypothesis to be tested, not an inevitable causal sequence.

STAGE	MECHANISM	STRUCTURAL ORIGIN
1	Retained-capability loss increases reacquisition pressure	Wrong gate admits wrong population
2	Cost pressure → more algorithmic quality management	No primitive correction; execution-layer response
3	More QA → more scoring opacity	Sensing-authority fusion deepens

STAGE	MECHANISM	STRUCTURAL ORIGIN
4	More opacity → more contributor frustration	Queue-state opacity; review route insufficiently legible
5	More frustration → more complaints and disputes	Legal and reputational exposure can increase
6	More compliance → stricter rubrics → wider expert-compliance gap	Guidelines deepen the signal-switch
7	Credentialed contributors disengage or are requalified → retained capability is lost	Cohort effect must be measured rather than assumed
8	More retained-capability loss → return to Stage 1	Recurrence remains structurally likely while the primitive remains unchanged

The deferral rule: interventions that leave the primitive intact remain vulnerable to recurrence of the diagnosed failure pattern.

SECTION 10

PROOF CONDITIONS

The redesign is real when it passes the same-pressure test:

> PROOF STANDARD
>
> ***Same pressure → different response.***

In one sentence for the board: when expert variance is no longer treated as reliability failure and the replacement architecture produces a measurably different response under the same pressure, the redesign is real.

Before a live redesign pilot begins, baseline measurements should be captured — contributor churn by tier, QM interpretation-ticket volume, Empty Queue duration, and deactivations or other irreversible consequences without human review. These are target measurement requirements; the public evidence does not establish that all four metrics are currently available internally.

The redesign is confirmed when all of the following hold:

- → Contributors do not reset to zero across projects — continuity is live and governs routing
- → Queue state is visible in the platform without external tools or QM explanation
- → QM interpretive support load has measurably fallen
- → Automated scores cannot trigger irreversible consequence without Review Node approval
- → The expert signal channel has changed upstream behaviour: at least one rubric, task boundary, or review rule has been altered by a Stream B signal during the pilot. A channel that receives submissions but alters nothing is a filing system, not a signal channel.
- → High-signal contributor churn (high-signal defined by validated performance, accepted expert signals or demonstrated work-type fit — not credentials) has measurably declined against baseline

SECTION 11

BOARD VERDICT

BOARD VERDICT

Replace the single broken contributor frame with a dual-stream architecture that separates reliability execution from expert judgment, restores contributor continuity across projects, and moves load-bearing coherence functions from informal work by Queue Managers and contributors into explicit system functions and governed roles. The stream split is fake without stream-specific compensation: expert judgment cannot be paid as throughput labour regardless of gate design. The redesign is not an optimisation of the current system. It is a structural replacement of the primitive that generates the failure.

The board choice is whether to replace the governing primitive or continue correcting inside it. The documented optimisation classes examined in the Diagnostic have not resolved the mismatch because they operate inside the existing contributor frame. Interface improvements can still be useful; they are not a substitute for primitive correction.

The Full Redesign Artifact is restricted and contains the complete transition sequence, move-by-move logic, rules and invariants, drift immune system with fail-closed primitive regression gates, admissibility conditions and stall-risk mitigations, pilot validity rules, object-level builder handoff, and automated testability requirements.

Next steps for the board

1. Formally resolve and lock the governing diagnosis before implementation-level redesign begins.
2. Where a Full Structural Engagement is commissioned, use Artifact 04 as the restricted builder specification for the six-move transition sequence, invariants, drift gates, admissibility conditions and builder handoff.
3. Treat the Diagnostic Resolution Record and Redesign Governance / Acceptance Record as exemplar governance devices rather than universal contract forms.

WHAT THIS DEMONSTRATES

This executive summary demonstrates what a structural replacement specification produces and how this practice approaches primitive-level systems failure. Artifact 04 sits underneath it with the complete builder specification and governed transition logic. The Diagnostic and Redesign together form a governed artifact pair: the diagnosis names and evidences the governing break; the redesign specifies the replacement. This public summary is not sufficient for implementation. It demonstrates the replacement logic without publishing the restricted transition detail, invariants, drift gates, admissibility work or builder-level architecture.

Delivery model: this redesign is specified independently of delivery model. The dual-stream architecture and contributor continuity record must remain under the platform's operational control and may not be transferred to a third-party vendor in a way that creates a new form of capture or custody loss.

To discuss access to the restricted Full Redesign Artifact or how this diagnostic and redesign methodology applies to your organisation, contact: **hello@jamieforrester.com** · jamieforrester.com

Prepared by Jamie Forrester, Independent Systems Architect, Edinburgh, UK. Produced independently — not commissioned by Outlier or Scale AI. Derived from the revised Diagnostic Artifact (public) and Full Redesign Artifact (restricted). This summary introduces no independent evidentiary claims. It summarises the replacement logic derived from those two artifacts. Public-evidence basis reviewed through September 2026.